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Case Studies

HR Search and Executive Appointments



Prepared for

Boston Consulting Group

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Years in HR search

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HR search is our expertise. These case studies show how we partner with global organisations to appoint HR leaders through transformation, growth and change.

WHERE WE DELIVER

Our Global Reach

From our offices in London and New York, we deliver HR search for clients across 17 countries.



UNITED STATES

United States



EUROPE

United Kingdom, Ireland, France, Germany, Netherlands,
Luxembourg, Switzerland, Spain, Denmark, Sweden, Poland,
Turkey



MIDDLE EAST

Saudi Arabia, Qatar, United Arab Emirates



AUSTRALIA

Australia

CASE STUDIES

Leadership for Transformation and Growth

TECHNOLOGY · PRIVATE EQUITY

01

CHRO Appointment for a Private Equity Backed Technology Business

📍 Munich

👤 CHRO

CONTEXT

A global technology business was undergoing a significant organisational separation and transformation following private equity investment. As it became a standalone organisation, it needed a CHRO to shape and deliver the people strategy, lead cultural change, build scalable HR infrastructure and manage complex stakeholder relationships across multiple regions.

METHODOLOGY

We ran a targeted international search, focusing on senior HR leaders with experience in transformation, organisational development, talent strategy and change management within complex multinational environments. Our assessment prioritised candidates who had led large scale cultural change, built HR functions in evolving organisations, partnered with executive leadership teams and operated across highly regulated international markets.

RESULTS

The successful candidate brought more than 20 years of experience leading people, talent, organisational development and transformation programmes across Europe, Asia and North America, and was ideally positioned to support the organisation through its next phase of growth and transformation.

FINANCIAL SERVICES · FINTECH

02

Empowering Leadership Development at a Global Fintech Firm

📍 New York and London

👤 Global Head of Executive Development

CONTEXT

The recruitment of a Global Head of Executive Development for a US headquartered investment research firm seeking to strengthen its senior leadership pipeline and drive ambitious growth goals.

METHODOLOGY

We conducted a targeted search, focusing on leadership development experts with experience of world class, market leading talent offerings. The search placed particular emphasis on matching each candidate's communication and delivery style to the firm's hands on, agile culture.

RESULTS

The appointed candidate reshaped the firm's executive talent team, using their subject matter expertise and pragmatic approach to refresh leadership development across the organisation. This contributed to the firm achieving its revenue and headcount growth objectives.

CASE STUDIES

Middle East Financial Services

SOVEREIGN WEALTH · REWARD

03

Head of Total Reward and Performance for a Sovereign Wealth Fund

📍 Middle East

👤 Head of Total Reward and Performance

CONTEXT

We partnered with a Middle East based sovereign wealth fund to hire its Head of Total Reward and Performance. This was a critical and confidential replacement, as the highly regarded incumbent had been with the organisation for five years. We met the Chief People Officer in person to take the full brief.

METHODOLOGY

The role called for a background in investment banking or asset management, the ability to work with senior leadership and deputise for the Chief People Officer, and the credibility to advise portfolio companies. We ran a global search across the major financial centres, including London, Singapore and New York, drawing on our network and our research capability. Each candidate was assessed on technical knowledge, motivation and appetite to relocate.

RESULTS

We sourced a candidate based in Australia who had previously held a Regional Head of Reward role in investment banking in Singapore.

BANKING · HR TRANSFORMATION

04

Building a Strategic HR Leadership Team for a UAE Bank's Transformation

📍 Abu Dhabi

👤 SVP HR Directors, Strategic HRBPs

CONTEXT

An Abu Dhabi headquartered bank asked us to hire a number of SVP level HR Business Partners as part of a transformation of its People function, following the appointment of a new Global Head of HR Business Partnering. The roles supported both infrastructure and revenue generating client groups, and needed strong leaders with C suite partnering experience, the ability to connect easily with people and a track record of supporting a business through growth and change.

METHODOLOGY

We targeted candidates from banking and retail and consumer organisations, researching talent at retail banks in Europe and Singapore that had undergone a similar transformation. We also searched for talent already based in the region within international banks and retail organisations.

RESULTS

We hired two SVP level HR Business Partners, one from a retail organisation in Dubai and one from a retail bank in Italy.

CASE STUDIES

Global Consumer Brand

CONSUMER · ORGANISATION DEVELOPMENT

05

Enhancing Organisational Effectiveness for a Global Consumer Brand

📍 London and Paris

👤 Head of OD and Change, Head of Capability

CONTEXT

The recruitment of two specialist roles, Head of Organisation Design and Change Management and Head of Organisation and Capability Development, for a global consumer brand implementing a new HR operating model.

METHODOLOGY

We conducted a targeted search, focusing on candidates who had created new functions within global, matrixed environments. The search emphasised change management expertise and the ability to navigate complex HR challenges at pace, identifying candidates from organisations that had undergone significant transformation.

RESULTS

Two highly experienced professionals were appointed. The Head of Organisation Design and Change Management brought a Big 4 consultancy background and experience of large scale business transformation in retail. The Head of Organisation and Capability Development brought experience of leading organisation development following a merger.

CONSUMER · PROJECT RECRUITMENT

06

Specialist HR Roles Project for a Global Consumer Brand

📍 London and Paris

👤 Eight specialist HR roles

CONTEXT

A global consumer brand needed to hire a number of specialist HR roles before the start of its financial year in July 2024. Its internal recruitment team faced capacity constraints and some roles required a sensitive hiring process, so it sought a specialist search partner offering support well beyond candidate sourcing. The roles spanned reward, internal communications, organisational development and learning and development, based in London or Paris.

METHODOLOGY

Our partnership covered writing effective job descriptions, market mapping and advertising the roles, and managing the entire recruitment process on behalf of hiring managers. We placed a dedicated consultant to run the process from start to finish.

RESULTS

We successfully hired eight specialist HR roles across London and Paris.

CASE STUDIES

Global Technology and Media

TECHNOLOGY · RAPID GROWTH

07

Addressing HR Challenges in a Rapidly Growing Global Technology Firm

📍 London and Amsterdam

👤 HR Director EMEA

CONTEXT

The recruitment of an HR Director EMEA for a global technology firm experiencing rapid growth. The firm needed an urgent replacement to support its expanding organisation and navigate the HR challenges that came with it.

METHODOLOGY

We ran a tailored search targeting highly commercial, global HR professionals able to thrive in ambiguous environments. Candidates were sourced from a broad range of sectors, including FMCG, technology, pharmaceuticals, management consultancy and investment banking, and each was assessed against specific criteria within a four week timeframe.

RESULTS

The appointed candidate, an experienced international HR Director with a background in banking, pharma and telecoms, brought the expertise to address the challenges of rapid growth and support the organisation's continued success.

MEDIA · TALENT PIPELINE

08

Pipelining Senior HR Talent for a Global Media Organisation

📍 London and Berlin

👤 Senior HRBP

CONTEXT

We partnered with a US headquartered media organisation to pipeline senior HR talent to support its growth in the region, in London and Berlin. Rather than filling a specific vacancy, the project set out to understand the availability of talent in both locations.

METHODOLOGY

We ran a tailored search in both markets, targeting highly commercial, global HR professionals able to thrive in ambiguous environments and drawing candidates from sectors including FMCG, technology, pharmaceuticals, management consultancy and investment banking. Each candidate was assessed against specific criteria within a four week timeframe.

RESULTS

We presented a longlist of twelve candidates for each location, all interviewed by Oakleaf to assess suitability, interest and compensation. The client interviewed four candidates in each location, and one Senior HRBP was appointed in London. The Berlin hire is planned for summer 2025.

CASE STUDIES

Reward and Transformation

SHIPPING · PLC REWARD

09

Navigating Transformation and Executive Remuneration for a UK Shipping Firm

📍 UK Wide

👤 Head of Reward

CONTEXT

The recruitment of a Head of Reward for a UK headquartered shipping PLC undergoing transformation and seeking to implement a comprehensive reward strategy, including executive remuneration.

METHODOLOGY

We conducted a targeted search, focusing on reward professionals with a strong track record of designing and delivering strategic reward frameworks within complex organisations undergoing transformation. The search emphasised an understanding of reward in a PLC with a varied workforce, and expertise in executive remuneration.

RESULTS

The appointed Head of Reward, a seasoned professional experienced in developing tailored compensation and benefits packages, designed and implemented an innovative reward strategy aligned with the firm's business objectives. This improved talent attraction and retention and enhanced employee engagement, particularly at executive level.

LET'S TALK

Partnering with Boston Consulting Group

We would welcome the opportunity to discuss how we can support your HR leadership hiring, wherever in the world you need us.



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To view our full capabilities visit cap.oakleafpartnership.com